SerpApi Korea Localization & Growth Strategy

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Dear SerpApi team,

Korea doesn't search like the rest of the world. It searches on Naver first, it builds with AI at full speed, and its developers trust what they find in Korean, from people they recognize.

I'm Theresa Tak, and I'm applying to be that person for SerpApi as your Developer Advocate (Korean). Instead of only telling you what I would do, I've already started: I built a Korean portfolio on SerpApi, wrote Korean content, and launched short-form channels to bring developers to it. This letter shares what I see in the Korean market, where I'd take SerpApi next, and the proof behind it.

Why me, in one line: I'm a professional Korean–English translator and conference interpreter, a developer shipping websites, AI automations and API integrations since 2023, and someone who has taught people technology every day at the Apple Store. Localize, build, teach: that's this job, and I already do all three.

My strategy in one idea: the Silicon Valley Bridge

I live in the San Francisco Bay Area, at the center of the AI tooling world, and my language, culture and target market are Korean. I want to turn that distance into SerpApi's advantage: **I'm the insider who brings the newest AI and search-data workflows from California to Korean developers, rebuilt for how Korea actually searches.**

Everything in this plan follows one path:

1. **The strategy:** the Silicon Valley Bridge, global AI workflows localized for a Naver-first market.
2. **The audiences:** four Korean segments, each with a specific problem (AI startups, e-commerce sellers, agencies, indie hackers).
3. **The campaigns:** three flagship campaigns that solve those problems in public.
4. **The engine:** short-form video on Instagram and YouTube as the front door, Korean developer communities as the meeting place.

5. **The conversion:** forkable GitHub templates and Korean tutorials, leading to a free SerpApi account.

Why the time zone helps, not hurts. My working day overlaps SerpApi's US team, and my evenings line up with Korea's mornings (Thursday evening in California is Friday morning in Seoul). I can stay close to product and engineering through SerpApi's async, written workflow, then run events and community time when Korean developers are online.

What I see in Korea today

SerpApi has already done the hard part in Korea. What's missing is the bridge to everyday Korean developers.

1. The trust is already there. Samsung is a SerpApi customer, alongside Nvidia, Shopify, Perplexity and Adobe. For a Korean CTO, "the same API Samsung uses" answers the first question before it's asked.

2. The product already speaks Naver. Korea is one of the few markets where Google isn't the default. SerpApi covers Naver with dedicated engines: Naver Nexearch for combined results, Naver News, and the Naver Maps API. But most examples lead with Google, so Korean developers can easily miss that this exists.

3. The gap is grassroots, and I'd measure it first. My hypothesis: many Korean startup developers, indie hackers and SEO agencies still write their own Selenium or BeautifulSoup scrapers for Naver, then keep fixing them when CAPTCHAs or layouts change. In my first weeks I'd test this by reviewing recent velog, Tistory and OKKY posts about collecting Naver data and recording what people actually use. That gives us a baseline and a number to move.

> **The opportunity:** take SerpApi from a tool a few large companies know to the tool every Korean developer reaches for when they need search data. Translation alone won't do that. The first tutorial a Korean developer finds has to solve a Korean problem, put Naver first, and work in five minutes.

The message I'd lead with isn't "get around Naver's defenses." It's simpler and more honest: **stop maintaining fragile scrapers, and get structured Naver and Google results from one API.**

Where I'd take SerpApi: grassroots localization

The plan has three parts: reach four audiences with Korean problems, bring them in through short-form video, and keep them with tutorials and code they can use the same day.

1. Four audiences, four Korean problems

Audience	Their pain today	The first thing I'd make for them
AI startups and LLM builders	Models don't know what's happening in Korea right now	Naver + Google real-time search for AI agents, with cited answers
E-commerce and D2C sellers	Checking competitors and prices by hand	Price and listing monitoring on Google Shopping and Naver
Local SEO and marketing agencies	Local results shift by neighborhood (a café search in Gangnam vs Hongdae), so rankings must be checked district by district	Local visibility tracking on Naver Map and Google Maps
Indie hackers and students	Scrapers that break in production when pages change or bots get blocked, often at 2 a.m.	"Stop fixing your Naver scraper" beginner series

2. Short-form video as the front door

Korean developers and founders discover tools on their phones first, so I've already started my own **Instagram** and **YouTube** channels for this work. Short Korean videos bring people in; the tutorials and templates below turn them into users. The full plan is in **The digital marketing engine** below.

The path: **short video → Korean tutorial → GitHub template → free SerpApi account.**

3. Content that keeps them

1. **Naver-first documentation.** Korean guides for Naver Nexearch, News and Maps, with copy-paste Python and JavaScript.

2. **Localized use cases, not translated pages.** Korean queries, Korean problems: Seongsu café rankings, Jeju travel results, Korean shopping prices.
3. **AI-native examples.** Real-time Korean search feeding LLM agents and marketing automations, where Korea's startup energy is right now.
4. **Open-source templates.** Every tutorial ships with a forkable GitHub repo and a Korean README.
5. **One Korean voice.** A shared style guide and glossary, so docs, blog posts and videos all sound consistent.

Where I'd show up in person

- **velog and Tistory:** in-depth Korean tutorials.
- **OKKY, GeekNews and Disquiet (디스콰이엇, often called Korea's Product Hunt):** launches, templates and real answers in discussions.
- **Inflearn and Nomad Coders communities:** helping students with data-collection questions.
- **Naver Cafe and Kakao open chats (개발자 오픈채팅방):** answering scraping and API questions, always saying who I am.
- **Meetups and online talks:** short Korean demos, starting with "adding real-time search to AI agents."

Three flagship campaigns

Each campaign targets one audience, feeds one stage of the funnel, and is something I can start in my first month.

Campaign 1: "LLM + Naver" open-source cookbook

For: AI startups and LLM builders. **Funnel role:** activation.

Korean teams are racing to build AI agents, but an agent is only as current as its data, and much of what Koreans read lives on Naver. The cookbook is a series of step-by-step GitHub repos and Korean tutorials that use SerpApi's Naver engines (plus Google) as the real-time search layer for AI agents and RAG.

- **The pitch:** "오늘의 네이버를 아는 한국어 AI 에이전트 만들기" (build a Korean AI agent that knows today's Naver).

- **Recipes:** cited Q&A agent (already built), Naver News trend digest, marketing-research agent, shopping-trend assistant.
- **Where:** GitHub, deep dives on velog and Tistory, launches on OKKY, GeekNews and Disquiet.
- **Why it works:** it moves SerpApi from "a scraper" to a core piece of the Korean AI stack.

Campaign 2: Silicon Valley Dev Link (monthly live sessions)

For: all four audiences, especially students and startup developers. **Funnel role:** interest and community.

A monthly live session on YouTube Live or Zoom, scheduled for Korean mornings (Thursday evening in California).

- **Technical workshop (30 min):** live-coding a real build, such as a Naver + Google search pipeline that scales with SerpApi instead of fragile scrapers.
- **Silicon Valley office hours (15 min):** open Q&A on tools, AI trends and developer culture in California.
- **After each session:** the recording becomes a long-form YouTube video and is cut into 3–4 Shorts.
- **Why it works:** Korean developers value a direct line to the global tech scene; a recurring, friendly session builds a loyal community around SerpApi.

Campaign 3: "Stop writing boilerplate" challenge

For: indie hackers, students and small startups. **Funnel role:** awareness.

A relatable content campaign about the pain of maintaining homegrown Selenium, Puppeteer and BeautifulSoup scrapers: broken selectors, CAPTCHAs, proxy pools and late-night fixes.

- **The message:** "개발자가 된 건 멋진 서비스를 만들려고지, 크롤러 고치려고가 아니잖아요." (You became a developer to build products, not to babysit scrapers.)
- **Formats:** developer memes, myth-vs-fact Reels, before/after code snippets (100 lines of scraper vs one API call).
- **The challenge:** replace one homegrown scraper with SerpApi and share the before/after; the best Korean submissions are featured on my channels.
- **Where:** Instagram and YouTube Shorts, GeekNews, LinkedIn, and Korean indie-hacker communities.
- **Why it works:** it speaks to developer pragmatism and gives them their time back.

The digital marketing engine

Organic short-form video builds awareness, Korean tutorials build trust, and tracked links show which content actually creates SerpApi users; paid ads come only after organic shows what works.

Channel mix

Channel	Role	Format	Rhythm
Instagram Reels (my channel)	Main awareness channel for founders and marketers	15–20 s Korean use-case videos, carousel tutorials, Stories with polls and links	3 Reels + 1 carousel a week
YouTube Shorts (my channel)	Reach developers searching for how-tos	Same short videos, titled as search questions ("네이버 검색 결과 API로 가져오는 법")	3 a week
YouTube long-form (my channel)	Depth and trust	8–15 min Korean tutorials and live-coding, linked from every Short	2 a month
TikTok and Naver Clip	Extra Korean reach at no extra cost	Reposts of the best Reels	As posted
velog, Tistory and my blog	Search traffic and the conversion step	Full Korean tutorials with code and repo links	2 a month
LinkedIn	Agencies, startup founders, partners	Short case posts and talk announcements	Weekly

Funnel and what I'd measure

Stage	Goal	Content	Metric
Awareness	Korean developers and founders learn SerpApi covers Naver	Reels, Shorts, the founder series	Reach, 3-second views, average watch time
Interest	They want to try it	Carousels, long-form tutorials, demo app	Saves, shares, profile and link clicks

Stage	Goal	Content	Metric
Activation	They make their first API call	Korean blog tutorial + GitHub template	UTM visits, template forks, sign-ups from Korean links
Community	They stay and tell others	Answers in communities, talks, Q&A Lives	Repeat questions, mentions, community invitations

Short-form ad library

Every video uses one of five repeatable formats, so production stays fast and results are comparable:

1. **Problem → fix (15 s):** "아직도 경쟁사 가격 손으로 확인해요?" then the API result on screen.
2. **Same query, two answers (18 s):** Naver vs Google side by side, using my live dashboard.
3. **Build in 60 seconds:** sped-up screen recording from empty file to working result.
4. **Founder story series (6 × 18 s):** a fictional Korean founder solving one problem per episode, AI character always labeled.
5. **Myth vs fact:** "크롤러 직접 만드는 게 더 싸다?" answered with maintenance time and reliability.

Assets each video needs: Korean burned-in captions, a hook in the first 2 seconds, real product footage, a thumbnail or cover in one consistent style, and a link with a UTM tag.

Paid amplification (after organic proves a winner)

- **Boost only proven videos.** Put a small test budget behind the 2–3 Reels or Shorts with the best organic watch time and saves.
- **Targeting:** Korean-speaking developers, startup founders and marketers (interests in programming, AI, startups, e-commerce).
- **Search intent:** test Naver and Google search ads on high-intent Korean keywords such as "네이버 크롤링", "검색 결과 API" and "네이버 뉴스 API", pointing to the matching Korean tutorial.
- **Retargeting:** show the free-account video to people who visited a tutorial but didn't sign up.

- **Budget and rules set with the team**, with every ad clearly from SerpApi once I'm on the team.

Partnerships and extras

- **Korean developer creators:** sponsored or co-made tutorials with Korean coding YouTubers and educators.
- **Community events:** live Q&A on Instagram or YouTube, giveaway of extra API credits for the best Korean project built with SerpApi.
- **Newsletter:** a monthly Korean roundup of new tutorials and templates for people who signed up.
- **Brand kit:** Korean templates for covers, captions and thumbnails so every post looks consistent.

Honesty rules for all marketing

- AI-generated people are always labeled, on every platform.
- Only real product footage and real results; no invented metrics.
- Until I'm hired, everything is clearly my own project, not an official SerpApi ad.

Proof: what I've already built

Before applying, I built a small version of this plan on SerpApi.

Piece	What it shows
Naver vs Google search dashboard (live)	One Korean query on both engines side by side, with overlapping sites and rank differences
Korean AI search agent (open source)	A Korean question answered from live Naver and Google results, with numbered sources
Korean tutorial	"SerpApi로 Naver와 Google 검색 결과 비교하기", on my blog and velog
Localized docs sample + style guide	A SerpApi docs page in natural Korean, with a glossary and translator's notes

Piece	What it shows
Feedback report	Findings from testing SerpApi's Korean results, logged the way I logged software issues as an Apple Vision Pro user-study proctor
Sample short-form videos for Instagram and YouTube	Korean short-form videos that drive viewers to the tutorial and templates
Short-form ad library + founder series	Six 18-second Korean episodes and five repeatable ad formats, AI characters clearly labeled

What I'd build next

Three more Naver-first templates, each with a tutorial, a repo and a short video:

1. **Naver News trend digest:** a daily Korean news summary on a topic like AI startups, sent to Slack or email.
2. **Naver vs Google Shopping price tracker:** daily price and seller tracking, with alerts when a competitor changes a price.
3. **Seoul district visibility map:** where a business ranks in local map results across Seoul, on Naver Map and Google Maps side by side.

30-60-90 day go-to-market plan for SerpApi Korea

Period	Theme	What I'd deliver	How I'd measure it
Days 1–30	Build the foundation	Adoption baseline (scrapers vs APIs in Korean posts); Korean feedback for the product team; Korean style guide, glossary and README template; first 2 Naver tutorials; Cookbook recipe #1 published; Instagram and YouTube posting rhythm set	Baseline ratio; feedback items accepted; first reach and watch-time numbers

Period	Theme	What I'd deliver	How I'd measure it
Days 31–60	Launch and seed	Short-form engine running (5 formats); "Stop writing boilerplate" challenge launched; first Silicon Valley Dev Link session; Cookbook recipes #2–3; launches on OKKY, velog, GeekNews and Disquiet	Saves and link clicks; repo stars and forks; session attendance; sign-ups from Korean UTM links
Days 61–90	Measure and scale	Funnel review by channel; paid test behind the best videos; Naver and Google search-ad test on top Korean keywords; creator partnerships; Korean docs for the top Naver engines; first local meetup talk	Cost per sign-up; repeat attendees; partner conversations; Korean docs traffic

I'd set budget and revenue-related goals with the team once I've seen SerpApi's open books, and report progress in writing, the same transparent, async way SerpApi already works.

Closing

Korea doesn't need a translated SerpApi. It needs a SerpApi that already feels local: **Naver first, Korean problems, a Korean voice, and a real person answering questions** where Korean developers gather, and on the phones where they discover new tools.

I'd love to be that person, and I've already started.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Theresa Tak

Project made for my SerpApi application. Live demo: naver-search-vs-google-search.vercel.app · Code: github.com/CodeByTak/serpapi-korean-portfolio